

The **Present Simple** and **Present Continuous** tenses are both used to describe actions or states in the present, but they serve different purposes. Here's a breakdown of when to use each tense:

Present Simple

Use the present simple for:

1. General Facts and Universal Truths:

- Things that are always true or generally accepted as facts.
- **Examples:**
 - Water boils at 100°C.
 - The sun rises in the east.

2. Habits and Routines:

- Actions that happen regularly, often with adverbs like "always," "usually," "often," "sometimes," "never," etc.
- **Examples:**
 - She walks to school every day.
 - I never drink coffee.

3. Permanent Situations:

- Things that are true for a long time or indefinitely.
- **Examples:**
 - He lives in London.
 - They work at a bank.

4. Scheduled Events:

- Timetables, programs, or schedules (e.g., public transport, classes, etc.).
- **Examples:**

- The train leaves at 6 p.m.
- School starts at 8:30.

5. **With Non-Action (State) Verbs:**

- Verbs that describe states, emotions, possession, or senses and are not usually used in continuous forms.
 - **Examples:**
 - I know the answer.
 - She loves chocolate.
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Present Continuous

Use the present continuous for:

1. **Actions Happening Right Now:**

- Actions taking place at the exact moment of speaking.
- **Examples:**
 - She is reading a book right now.
 - They are playing football outside.

2. **Temporary Situations:**

- Actions or states that are temporary or happening around now, but not permanently.
- **Examples:**
 - I'm staying with my cousin this week.
 - He is working as a waiter this summer.

3. **Trends or Changes Happening Over Time:**

- Situations or actions that are in progress and evolving.

- **Examples:**

- The climate is getting warmer.
- More people are using electric cars.

4. **Planned Future Actions:**

- For personal plans or arrangements in the near future (often with a specific time or context).

- **Examples:**

- We are meeting them for lunch tomorrow.
- She is flying to Paris next week.

5. **Repetitive Actions with Emphasis or Annoyance:**

- Actions that happen repeatedly, often with adverbs like "always" or "constantly" to show irritation or exaggeration.

- **Examples:**

- He is always losing his keys!
- You're constantly interrupting me.

Key Differences

Present Simple	Present Continuous
Regular, habitual actions	Temporary, in-progress actions
General facts	Actions happening right now
Permanent situations	Temporary situations or changes

Present Simple	Present Continuous
Schedules and timetables	Planned future actions
State verbs (e.g., like, know, own)	Rarely used with state verbs

Common Errors to Avoid

1. **Using the present continuous with state verbs:**
 - Incorrect: I am knowing the answer.
 - Correct: I know the answer.
2. **Using the present simple for actions happening right now:**
 - Incorrect: She reads a book.
 - Correct: She is reading a book.

PRACTICE PART I

Here are some practice exercises to help you master the difference between **present simple** and **present continuous**.

1. Fill in the blanks

Choose the correct form of the verb in parentheses (**present simple** or **present continuous**).

1. She always _____ (wake up) at 7 a.m. on weekdays.
2. Look! It _____ (rain) outside right now.
3. My parents _____ (live) in Spain, but this summer they _____ (stay) in Italy.
4. He _____ (not understand) why you are upset.
5. The train _____ (leave) at 5:30 p.m. every day.
6. I _____ (work) on a big project this month, so I _____ (not have) much free time.



7. They usually _____ (play) tennis on Saturdays, but today they _____ (go) hiking.
 8. Listen! The baby _____ (cry) in the next room.
 9. She _____ (enjoy) reading books about history.
 10. You're always _____ (interrupt) me when I'm speaking!
-

2. Correct the mistakes

Each sentence below has an error. Rewrite it correctly.

1. He is knowing the answer to the question.
 2. I am going to the gym every Friday.
 3. They works hard during the week.
 4. Look! The cat plays with the ball.
 5. She not likes ice cream.
 6. We are staying in this hotel every summer.
 7. I am usually cooking dinner at 6 p.m.
 8. The movie starts now.
 9. Why you are always forgetting your keys?
 10. He go to the park every weekend.
-

3. Match the sentences

Match the following sentences to their correct descriptions:

Sentence	Description
1. She is baking a cake.	A. Habitual action
2. The Earth orbits the Sun.	B. Temporary situation
3. We are staying at a hotel this week.	C. General fact

Sentence**Description**

4. He never drinks coffee.

D. Action happening right now

5. The concert starts at 8 p.m.

E. Scheduled event

4. Create your own sentences

Write your own sentences using the following prompts:

1. A habitual action (present simple).
 2. Something happening right now (present continuous).
 3. A temporary situation (present continuous).
 4. A general fact (present simple).
 5. An action expressing annoyance (present continuous with “always”).
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5. Identify the tense

Read each sentence and decide if it uses the present simple or present continuous.

1. We are going to the mall after school.
 2. She studies French on Mondays.
 3. I am learning how to play the piano this year.
 4. They don't understand the question.
 5. He is always borrowing my things without asking!
-

6. Complete the dialogue

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb.

A: Hi! What _____ (you/do) here?

B: Oh, I _____ (wait) for my sister. She _____ (shop) for some clothes.

A: Really? I _____ (not see) her. Does she usually come here?

B: Yes, she _____ (love) shopping at this mall. What about you?

A: I _____ (look) for a new pair of shoes.



PRACTICE PART II

Here are more exercises to give you additional practice with **present simple** and **present continuous**:

1. Multiple Choice

Choose the correct option to complete each sentence.

1. Right now, he _____ (a. watches / b. is watching) TV in the living room.
 2. She usually _____ (a. goes / b. is going) to the gym in the evenings.
 3. Listen! The birds _____ (a. sing / b. are singing) so beautifully.
 4. I _____ (a. don't know / b. am not knowing) the answer to this question.
 5. They _____ (a. play / b. are playing) tennis every weekend.
 6. This month, we _____ (a. stay / b. are staying) at a nice hotel near the beach.
 7. He _____ (a. reads / b. is reading) a very interesting book at the moment.
 8. Water _____ (a. boils / b. is boiling) at 100°C.
-

2. Fill in the blanks with negative forms

Use the negative form of the present simple or present continuous.

1. I _____ (not watch) TV right now.
 2. She _____ (not like) spicy food.
 3. We _____ (not go) to the park every day.
 4. They _____ (not play) football at the moment.
 5. He _____ (not understand) the instructions.
 6. I _____ (not work) this weekend because I'm on vacation.
-

3. Write questions

Turn the following sentences into questions using the correct tense.

1. She is working on a new project.
Question: _____?
 2. They play chess on Saturdays.
Question: _____?
 3. He is listening to music right now.
Question: _____?
 4. You know her phone number.
Question: _____?
 5. The bus leaves at 7 a.m. every day.
Question: _____?
-

4. Sentence Scramble

Rearrange the words to form correct sentences in the appropriate tense.

1. are / right now / they / laughing / at a joke.
 2. never / coffee / drinks / she / in the morning.
 3. playing / football / he / is / with his friends.
 4. starts / train / the / at 9 p.m. / every day.
 5. staying / for a month / we / at this hotel / are.
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5. Describe the pictures

Imagine the following situations and write sentences in the correct tense:

1. A man is riding a bicycle in the park.
2. A group of students are sitting in a classroom and studying.
3. A woman walks her dog in the early morning every day.
4. The sun is setting over the mountains.
5. He always forgets his umbrella when it rains.

6. Mixed Tense Practice

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb (present simple or present continuous).

1. My brother _____ (study) engineering at university.
 2. The children _____ (play) in the garden right now.
 3. She _____ (usually / cook) dinner at 7 p.m.
 4. Why _____ (you / not listen) to me right now?
 5. This machine _____ (not work) properly—it needs repair.
 6. The company _____ (grow) rapidly this year.
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7. Error Identification

Find and correct the errors in these sentences.

1. She do not understand why he is always late.
 2. The teacher explain the lesson right now.
 3. I am thinking this dress looks good on you.
 4. They stays in that apartment for a long time.
 5. He is never drinking tea in the morning.
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PRACTICE PART III

Here's another set of **present simple** and **present continuous** exercises for more variety and challenge:

1. Fill in the blanks with verbs

Choose the correct verb in parentheses and use the appropriate tense (**present simple** or **present continuous**).

1. Every morning, she _____ (drink) coffee before starting work.



2. The children _____ (not go) to school today because it's a holiday.
 3. Look! That dog _____ (chase) a squirrel in the park.
 4. I _____ (not believe) in ghosts, but he _____ (always talk) about them!
 5. We _____ (visit) my grandparents this weekend—they're so excited.
 6. The moon _____ (not give) its own light; it reflects sunlight.
 7. Why _____ (you / look) at me like that? Did I say something wrong?
 8. John usually _____ (take) the bus, but today he _____ (drive) to work.
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2. Choose the correct sentence

Identify which of the two options is correct.

1. a. He is usually waking up early.
b. He usually wakes up early.
 2. a. The cake smells amazing.
b. The cake is smelling amazing.
 3. a. She is studying for her exams this week.
b. She studies for her exams this week.
 4. a. I think this is a great idea.
b. I am thinking this is a great idea.
 5. a. They are playing football every Saturday.
b. They play football every Saturday.
-

3. Error Correction

Identify and correct the errors in these sentences.

1. He is going to the gym every day.
2. We doesn't usually eat lunch this late.
3. I am hearing strange noises outside right now.

4. She always is watching TV before bed.
 5. The movie is starts at 8 p.m.
-

4. Spot the Difference

Each pair of sentences has one key difference. Explain the difference in meaning.

1. a. She always forgets her homework.
b. She is always forgetting her homework.
 2. a. We live in London.
b. We are living in London.
 3. a. He thinks she's talented.
b. He's thinking about moving abroad.
 4. a. I read books every evening.
b. I'm reading a book about history right now.
 5. a. The baby cries at night.
b. The baby is crying right now.
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5. Creative Writing

Write sentences or a short paragraph using the following prompts:

1. Describe what you usually do on weekends (use **present simple**).
 2. Imagine you're on a beach right now. Describe what's happening around you (use **present continuous**).
 3. Write about a family member's habits that annoy you (use **present continuous** with "always").
 4. Write about a science fact you recently learned (use **present simple**).
 5. Plan your weekend activities as if they are already arranged (use **present continuous** for future plans).
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6. Dialogue Completion

Complete the dialogue with the correct tense:



A: Hi! What _____ (you / do) these days?

B: Oh, I _____ (work) on a new project at the office. It's super exciting!

A: Really? That's great. Do you like it?

B: Yes, I do. But I _____ (not have) much free time now because of it.

A: That makes sense. Are you free this weekend?

B: No, I _____ (visit) my grandparents. What about you?

7. Rewrite the sentences

Rewrite the sentences using the tense specified.

1. She usually watches TV in the evening. (**present continuous**)
 2. They are building a new shopping mall in our town. (**present simple**)
 3. The bus leaves at 9 a.m. every day. (**present continuous**)
 4. I'm learning Spanish right now. (**present simple**)
 5. He always forgets to lock the door. (**present continuous**)
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PRACTICE PART IV:

Here are exercises that involve sentences combining both the **present simple** and **present continuous** to help you understand how they work **together**:

1. Fill in the blanks

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verb in parentheses.

1. She usually _____ (wake up) at 7 a.m., but today she _____ (sleep) until 9 a.m. because it's a holiday.
2. I _____ (know) he _____ (work) late this week to finish the project.
3. My dog _____ (bark) at strangers, but right now he _____ (play) with the neighbor's cat!

4. We _____ (visit) our grandparents this weekend, but we normally _____ (stay) home on Saturdays.
5. He _____ (not usually eat) much for breakfast, but today he _____ (enjoy) pancakes and eggs.
-

2. Match the clauses

Match the beginnings of sentences (A) with their endings (B).

A

B

1. She usually studies in the library,	a. but this week they are working from home.
2. He always drinks coffee in the morning,	b. but this year he is studying online.
3. My parents work in an office,	c. but right now she is working at a coffee shop.
4. We go to the gym every Tuesday,	d. but today he is having tea instead.
5. He usually attends classes in person,	e. but today we are playing tennis at the park.

3. Rewrite the sentences

Combine the two sentences into one, using the present simple and the present continuous.

1. He usually walks to work. Today, he is taking the bus.
Example: He usually walks to work, but today he is taking the bus.
2. She always writes emails in the morning. Right now, she is making a phone call.
3. We normally spend weekends at home. This weekend, we are going camping.
4. They play soccer every Saturday. Today, they are watching a match instead.
5. I usually read fiction books. Currently, I am reading a biography.

4. Error Correction

Each sentence has one incorrect use of the tense. Rewrite the sentence correctly.

1. He is going to the gym every day, but this week he takes a break.
 2. She always is working on weekends, but today she relaxes.
 3. I usually don't drink coffee, but right now I drink it because I'm tired.
 4. They attend a French class every week, but this week they are not going because they take a vacation.
 5. We eat dinner at 7 p.m. every evening, but today we eat at 8 because we are waiting for a guest.
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5. Create Your Own Sentences

Use the prompts to create sentences that combine **present simple** and **present continuous**.

1. Describe a daily habit and how today is different.
Example Prompt: I usually drink tea in the evening, but...
 2. Talk about a regular activity that is temporarily changed.
Example Prompt: She normally works at the office, but...
 3. Compare what someone always does to what they are doing right now.
Example Prompt: He always... but today...
 4. Write about what a friend or family member is currently doing compared to their usual behavior.
Example Prompt: My sister usually... but this week...
 5. Describe your typical weekend routine and what's happening this weekend.
-

6. Complete the Dialogue

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb in parentheses.

A: What _____ (you / usually / do) on Sundays?

B: I normally _____ (go) to the park with my family, but today we _____ (visit) the

museum instead.

A: That sounds fun! Why _____ (you / decide) to change plans?

B: Well, the weather _____ (not look) good, and my kids _____ (really enjoy) museums.

Here's another set of exercises where **present simple** and **present continuous** are used together in the same sentence:

PRACTICE PART V

1. Fill in the blanks

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in parentheses.

1. She _____ (not usually work) on weekends, but she _____ (help) her friend today.
 2. He _____ (visit) his parents this weekend, even though he normally _____ (spend) Sundays at home.
 3. I _____ (think) this dress looks nice, but I _____ (try) another one on now.
 4. My brother _____ (not watch) TV much, but he _____ (follow) a new series right now.
 5. We _____ (take) a different route today because we _____ (normally drive) on the highway.
-

2. Sentence Transformation

Rewrite the sentences to include both the **present simple** and **present continuous**.

1. I usually go to bed at 10 p.m. Tonight, I'm staying up late to finish my homework.
Example: I usually go to bed at 10 p.m., but tonight I'm staying up late to finish my homework.
2. She always eats breakfast at home. Today, she's having breakfast at a café.

3. They normally shop at the local market. This week, they're shopping at the supermarket.
 4. I usually walk to work. Today, I'm taking a taxi because it's raining.
 5. We always visit the same beach in summer. This year, we're exploring a new destination.
-

9. Match the halves

Match the beginnings (A) with the correct endings (B).

A

B

1. He normally studies in the library,	a. but they are staying with us this week.
2. She always travels by train,	b. but right now she is learning to swim.
3. My parents live in the countryside,	c. but this week he is preparing at home.
4. She usually relaxes by reading a book,	d. but today she is driving because the trains are delayed.
5. She normally spends her summers hiking,	e. but today she is watching a movie instead.

10. Spot the Difference

Read the sentences below and explain the difference in meaning.

1. a. He works from home every day.
b. He is working from home today.
2. a. She plays the piano beautifully.
b. She is playing the piano in the living room right now.

3. a. I usually wear jeans to work.
b. I am wearing a dress today because of the party.
 4. a. The bus leaves at 6 p.m. every evening.
b. The bus is leaving earlier than usual today.
 5. a. They always eat lunch at 1 p.m.
b. They are eating lunch at 1:30 today because the meeting ran late.
-

11. Combine the Sentences

Combine the following sentences into one that uses both the **present simple** and **present continuous**.

1. I usually drink coffee in the morning. Right now, I'm drinking tea.
 2. She writes reports every day. Today, she's preparing a presentation instead.
 3. They visit their grandparents on weekends. This weekend, they're visiting their cousins.
 4. He plays tennis on Fridays. Today, he's playing basketball.
 5. We normally stay in a hotel during vacations. This time, we're renting an apartment.
-

12. Mixed-Tense Dialogue

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs in parentheses (**present simple** or **present continuous**).

A: Hi, Sarah! What _____ (you / usually / do) on Saturdays?

B: I normally _____ (go) to yoga class, but today I _____ (stay) at home to relax.

A: That's nice! I _____ (know) you love yoga. _____ (you / plan) to go back next week?

B: Yes, definitely! By the way, what _____ (you / do) now?

A: I _____ (shop) for a new phone online because mine _____ (not work) properly.

13. Error Correction

Find and fix the errors in the following sentences.

1. He usually is waking up at 7 a.m., but today he sleeps until 9.
 2. She does not like coffee, but she drinks it right now because she is very tired.
 3. They usually are taking the bus to work, but today they drive because the bus is late.
 4. The weather always is cold in winter, but today it rains.
 5. I read a lot of books, but this week I am reading a magazine instead.
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14. Describe These Scenarios

Write sentences using both **present simple** and **present continuous** for the following situations:

1. You usually eat lunch at home, but today you are eating at a restaurant.
 2. Your friend always wears casual clothes, but today they are wearing formal attire for a special occasion.
 3. You typically study at the library, but this week you are studying at home.
 4. Your coworker usually arrives at work on time, but today they are arriving late because of traffic.
 5. You and your family usually go on vacation in summer, but this year you are staying home.
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PRACTICE PART VI

Fill in the blanks with either the **Present Simple** or **Present Continuous** form of the verbs in parentheses.

A Busy Day at the Park

Every weekend, Anna _____ (go) to the park near her house. She _____ (love) spending time outdoors because it _____ (make) her feel refreshed and happy. Usually, she _____ (walk) her dog, Max, and they _____ (play) together in the open field. But today, things _____ (be) a bit different.

Right now, Anna _____ (sit) on a bench while Max _____ (run) around with other dogs. The park _____ (look) busier than usual because the weather _____ (be) perfect. The sun _____ (shine), and a cool breeze _____ (blow) through the trees.

Nearby, a group of children _____ (play) tag. They _____ (laugh) and _____ (chase) each other around the swings. Their parents _____ (relax) on picnic blankets, chatting and enjoying the sunshine.

Anna _____ (notice) an ice cream truck parked by the entrance. People _____ (line up) to buy cold treats. She _____ (think) about getting some for herself, but first, she _____ (check) to make sure Max _____ (stay) out of trouble.

A little boy _____ (try) to pet Max, and Anna _____ (smile) as she watches. Max _____ (always / love) meeting new people, so he _____ (wag) his tail excitedly.

This is why Anna _____ (come) to the park every weekend—it _____ (always / feel) like the perfect place to relax and enjoy life.

Here's another **gap-fill story** using the **present simple** and **present continuous**. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs in parentheses.

A Day at the Market

Every Saturday, Maria _____ (visit) the local farmers' market in her neighborhood. She _____ (enjoy) buying fresh fruits and vegetables, and she _____ (always / find) something special to bring home.

Today, Maria _____ (carry) a basket as she _____ (walk) through the busy stalls. The vendors _____ (call out) to customers, trying to sell their goods. One man _____ (shout), "Fresh strawberries! Sweet and juicy!" while another _____ (offer) handmade bread and pastries.

Maria _____ (stop) at a flower stall and _____ (look) at the colorful bouquets. She _____ (love) flowers, and she _____ (usually / buy) a bunch to brighten her living room. Right now, she _____ (decide) whether to get sunflowers or tulips.

Nearby, a little girl _____ (hold) her mother's hand and _____ (point) excitedly at some shiny red apples. "Mom, can we buy these?" she _____ (ask). Her mother _____ (nod) and _____ (pick up) a bag of apples.

Maria _____ (notice) a stall selling homemade jams and jellies. The seller _____ (explain) how she _____ (make) them with fruit from her own garden. Maria _____

(try) a sample of the raspberry jam and _____ (think) it's delicious. She _____ (buy) two jars to take home.

As Maria _____ (leave) the market, she _____ (feel) happy and satisfied. She _____ (always / love) this part of her weekend because it _____ (bring) her closer to her community and the simple joys of life.

Here's another **gap-fill story** using the **present simple** and **present continuous**. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs in parentheses.

An Afternoon at the Café

Every afternoon, Liam _____ (go) to his favorite café after work. He _____ (enjoy) the peaceful atmosphere and the smell of freshly brewed coffee. The café _____ (always / play) soft jazz music, which _____ (help) him relax.

Today, Liam _____ (sit) by the window, sipping his cappuccino. Outside, people _____ (walk) by, and the street _____ (buzz) with activity. A man on a bicycle _____ (ride) past, and a group of teenagers _____ (chat) loudly as they _____ (wait) for the bus.

Inside the café, the barista _____ (prepare) drinks while a customer _____ (pay) at the counter. Liam _____ (watch) as the barista carefully _____ (pour) milk into a cup, creating a beautiful latte art design.

Liam usually _____ (bring) a book to read, but today he _____ (work) on his laptop. He _____ (try) to finish a report for work, but his mind _____ (wander). He _____ (think) about the vacation he _____ (plan) for next month.

Suddenly, he _____ (hear) someone call his name. It's his friend Sarah, who _____ (wave) at him from the door. She _____ (smile) as she _____ (walk) over to his table. "What _____ (you / do) here?" she _____ (ask).

"I _____ (just / relax) after work," Liam replies. "What about you?"

"I _____ (grab) a coffee before heading to the library," Sarah says. "Mind if I join you for a bit?"

"Of course not," Liam _____ (say), pulling out a chair for her.

As they _____ (chat) and _____ (catch up), Liam _____ (realize) how much he _____ (appreciate) these simple moments with friends.

Recommended Videos:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GLF0IHOtIs>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UeaaaMx-Wec&t=9s>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n3b2mW69KWA>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YJM32eh5UCM>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wPw9ybsZKos>